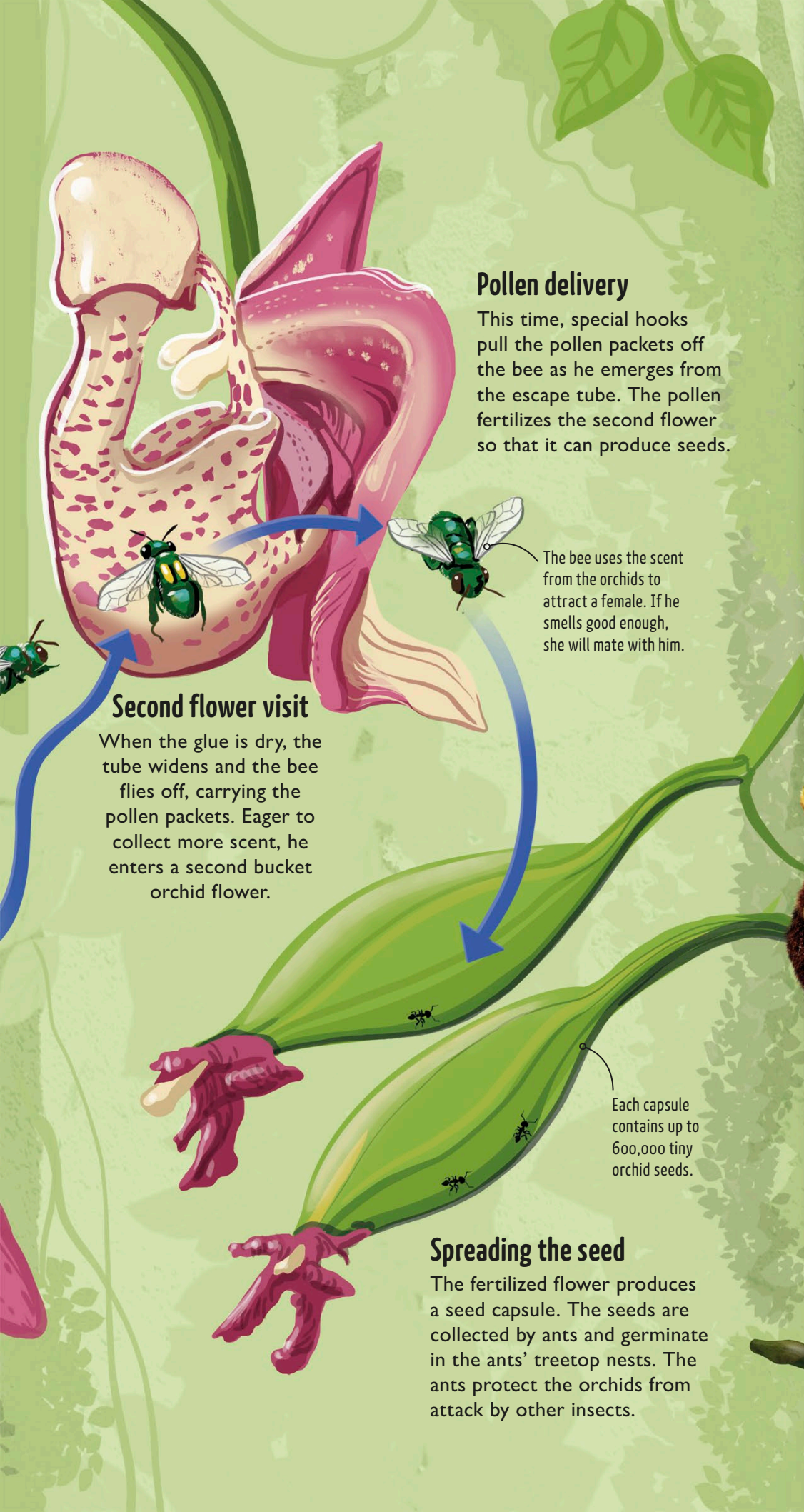




Pollen delivery

This time, special hooks pull the pollen packets off the bee as he emerges from the escape tube. The pollen fertilizes the second flower so that it can produce seeds.

The bee uses the scent from the orchids to attract a female. If he smells good enough, she will mate with him.

Second flower visit

When the glue is dry, the tube widens and the bee flies off, carrying the pollen packets. Eager to collect more scent, he enters a second bucket orchid flower.

Each capsule contains up to 600,000 tiny orchid seeds.

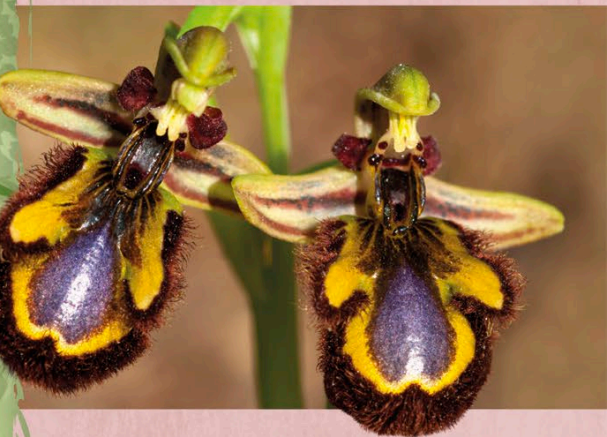
Spreading the seed

The fertilized flower produces a seed capsule. The seeds are collected by ants and germinate in the ants' treetop nests. The ants protect the orchids from attack by other insects.

Lily The petals of an Amazon giant water lily close around visiting scarab beetles that are attracted by the flower's scent. When the beetles are released the next day, they fly off and carry pollen to other giant lilies.



Mirror orchids These orchids look and smell like the females of a particular species of wasp. When the male wasps try to mate with the flowers, they pick up pollen and transfer it to the next orchid they visit.



Darwin's orchid Morgan's sphinx moth is the only insect able to pollinate Darwin's orchid. No other moth has a proboscis long enough to reach deep into the flower to sip its nectar.

